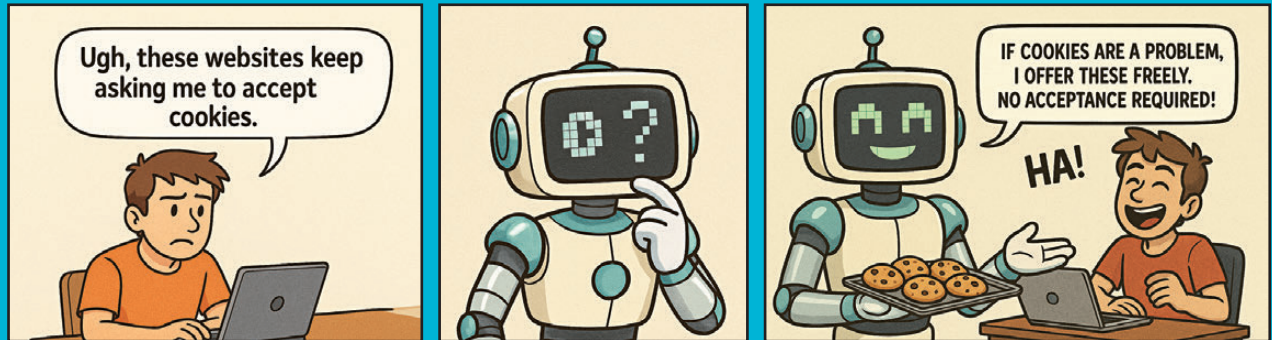


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Sam Altman's ChatGPT openly challenges DeepSeek, Meta for open source AI

The great Open Source AI wars have begun, and it will benefit us all

—By Jayesh Shinde

On a quiet Tuesday morning, OpenAI CEO Sam Altman casually tossed a stone into the AI pond with two back-to-back posts on X.com. The ripples are still forming, but they're only going to get bigger and broader.

"We are planning to release our first open-weight language model since GPT-2," Altman said, in what may turn out to be a milestone moment for open AI development. Then came the follow-up, laced with just enough snark to make it stick. "We will not do anything silly like saying that you can't use our open model if your service has more than 700 million monthly active users. We want everyone to use it!"

If that sounds like a thinly veiled swipe at Meta's Llama license restrictions, that's because it is. Far from a simple product announcement, it's a gauntlet being thrown in the open-source AI arena, announcing that ChatGPT is ready for a fight.

ChatGPT "open-weight" model: What is it?

Let's start with the basics. OpenAI is preparing to release a new "open-weight" model – one with advanced reasoning capabilities. That means developers will get access to the model's actual neural network weights, making it possible to run, fine-tune, and build on top of it without starting



from scratch. It's what we are all used to seeing on Hugging Face Spaces, for instance – a playground for developers to tweak and tinker with a foundational LLM model and release their versions by playing around with their "weights".

This is a big deal, especially for open source AI. While GPT-2 was the last

OpenAI model with weights available to the public, things have changed. The AI arms race has heated up. Everyone's building their own large language models – some more open than others.

And that's the point. Altman isn't just releasing a model. He's taking a very public position in an industry where the definition of "open" has gotten suspiciously flexible.

ChatGPT open-weight model: What's next?

OpenAI says the model will go through its internal "preparedness framework" before release. That includes safety checks, performance benchmarks, and stress tests to ensure it won't be misused or go off the rails. That's especially important because open-weight models can – and will – be modified after release.

If the model is good – and Altman says it will be "very, very good" – developers will start building fast. Expect plug-ins, fine-tuned niche apps, industry-specific tools, and unexpected use cases. tinyurl.com/5n8zursn